

II. The Valley of Kashmir was formed in a synclinorium.

III. The Gangetic plain was formed in a fore deep.

IV. The Himalayas originated as a result of triangular convergence of the Indian Plate, the European Plate and the Chinese Plate.

Which of these statements are correct?

- (a) I, II and III (b) I, III and IV
(c) I and III (d) II and IV

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

Meghalaya Plateau is an extension of the Peninsular Plateau. It is believed that due to the force exerted by the north eastward movement of the Indian plate at the time of the Himalayan origin, a huge fault was created between the Rajmahal hills and the Meghalaya plateau. Later, this depression got filled up by the deposition activity of numerous rivers. Today, the Meghalaya and Karbi Anglong plateau stand detached from the main Peninsular Block. Thus statement (1) is correct. The Valley of Kashmir was formed in a synclinorium. The Indo-Gangetic basin is an active foreland basin having east-west elongated shape. The basin formed in response to the uplift of Himalaya after the collision of India and China plates (Dewey and Bird, 1970). Suess (1893-1909) was the first geologist to suggest that the Indo-Gangetic depression is a 'fore-deep' and was formed in front of the high crust-waves of the Himalayas as their southward migration was resisted by the rigid landmass of the Peninsula.

Thus statement (3) is also correct. The Himalayan mountain range and Tibetan Plateau have formed as a result of the collision between the Indian plate and the Eurasian plate. Chinese plate is not mentioned in the theory of plate tectonics. Thus statement (4) is wrong.

4. Which of the following is *not* a peculiarity of middle Gangetic plain agroclimatic region?

- (a) Located in Ganga and its tributaries' drainage area
(b) Extended in more than two States
(c) Receives more than 100 cm rain annually
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (e)

Middle Gangetic Plain agroclimatic region is a fertile plain drained by Ganga and its tributaries. It is extended in more than two states and receives more than 100 cm rain annually. Hence option (e) is the correct answer

ii. Northern Mountainous Region

1. The foothills region of Himalayas is –

- (a) Trans-Himalayas (b) Shiwalik
(c) Great Himalayas (d) Aravali

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Ans. (b)

The foothills region of the Himalaya is called Shiwalik. These are the outermost ranges of the Himalayas. They extend over a width of 10-50 Km and have an altitude varying between 900 to 1100 meters. These ranges are composed of unconsolidated sediments brought down by rivers from the main Himalayan ranges located farther north.

2. Which of the following areas is not landslide-prone area?

- (a) Western Ghats
(b) Eastern Ghats
(c) Himalayan Regions
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (b)

Landslides are the gravitational movement of rocks, masses of earth, or debris through the mountain slopes. Hilly slopes become unstable due to groundwater pressure, earthquakes, erosions and volcanic eruptions, which causes landslides. Western Ghats and Himalayan Regions are landslide prone area while Eastern Ghats areas is not landslide prone area. Hence option (b) is the correct answer.

3. The highest peak in the Eastern Ghats of India is :

- (a) Anai Mudi (b) Kanchenjunga
(c) Mahendragiri (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (c)

Mahendragiri is the highest peak in the Eastern Ghats of India. It is located in Odisha, in the Rayagada block of the Eastern Ghats.

4. Shiwalik series was formed in –

- (a) Aozoic (b) Paleozoic
(c) Mesozoic (d) Cenozoic

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)